Session 3 Handout: API Fundamentals for Non-Engineers

Advanced Prompting & API Integration · MSc AI and Digital Strategy Management

1. API vocabulary in one table

Term	Plain meaning	Example
API	A set of rules to ask another service for something	A weather service you can query
Endpoint	The address you call	`api.open-meteo.com/v1/forecast`
Request	Your question: address, method, parameters	Latitude and longitude of a city
Response	The answer, usually JSON	A block of labelled values
Authentication	Proof you may ask, often an API key	A secret string, never shared
Status code	A number saying what happened	200 OK, 401 key problem, 404 not found, 429 too many requests

2. Documentation reading checklist

For any API, find these five things before you build anything.

Item	What I found
Endpoint	
Parameters (required and optional)	
Authentication needed?	
Example response	
Usage limits	

3. Workshop 1: first API call log

Question	My answer
API used	
Request (address and parameters)	
Status code returned	

Question	My answer
The one value I extracted	
Parameter I changed and what happened	

4. Workshop 2: integration canvas

Keep it minimal: one AI step, one API call, one real input.

Part	My design
Business task	
Pattern (API → AI or AI → API)	
Input	
API used and why	
AI step (prompt from Session 2)	
Output format passed between the steps	
Result of the end-to-end run	

5. If it fails

Symptom	Check first
401 or access denied	Is the key present and pasted correctly?
404 not found	Is the address or a parameter misspelt?
429 too many requests	Have you called too often? Wait and retry once.
Empty or odd result	Did you read the example response in the documentation?
AI step ignores the data	Is the data actually inserted into the prompt?

6. Safe habits

- Never paste an API key into a chat, a slide or a shared document.
- Do not use personal or confidential data in test calls.
- Know the usage limits and costs before you run anything in a loop.

7. Deliverable

A working minimal API integration, due as agreed with your instructor.

- A screenshot of the working run, with any key hidden

- Three lines: what it does, which API, which AI step
- Email both to fabien.gueret-jullien@bsb-education.com
- Subject line: `[Session 3] Surname – Integration`

8. Preview of Session 4

We extend your integration into a multi-step workflow: several calls, basic error handling and design for reliability.